Neon Haven: How to Play

The goal

Grow the biggest city you can. Your score is your **peak population**. Every city ends eventually: disasters and costs rise each year, so the question is how big you can get and how long you last.

Controls (phone first)

Tap a tool in the bottom bar, then tap a tile to build. **Drag** to move the map. **Pinch** (or mouse wheel) to zoom.

Top-right buttons: pause (you can still build while paused), 1×/2×/4× speed, mute, save and go to menu.

Upgrade raises a building to level 2 or 3 (shown as stars). Demolish refunds 50% and also clears trees.

Your first two minutes

1. Build a Power Plant near the centre.
2. Lay a line of Road next to it.
3. Put Homes, a Farm and a Shop along the road, inside the yellow power radius shown when you hover/place.
4. Watch the HUD: keep Food ≥ Pop, Jobs ≈ Pop and Power use below supply.

A building that is not working turns dark red and shows a floating (needs a road) or (needs power).

Buildings

Building	Cost	What it does
Road	$10	Connects buildings. Everything except roads must touch one.
Homes	$60	+6 residents per level. Uses 1 power.
Farm	$70	Feeds 14 people, 3 jobs. No power needed.
Shop	$120	6 jobs and tax.
Power Plant	$300	30 power per level, radius 4 (+1 per level).
Park	$80	+8 happiness to homes within 2 tiles.
Factory	$240	12 jobs and big tax, but -12 happiness to nearby homes. Unlocks at 40 pop.
Fire Station	$260	Puts out fires within 5 tiles. Unlocks at 60 pop.
Clinic	$400	+5% happiness citywide per level. Unlocks at 100 pop.
Office	$500	16 jobs, highest tax. Unlocks at 160 pop.
Arcology	$1,400	+40 residents landmark tower. Unlocks at 300 pop.

Prices rise 2% each year. Upkeep is charged monthly and grows with difficulty.

The HUD

money, net income per month, population and peak, happiness, power used/supply, food, jobs, date. Red, blinking stats are problems. The tip bubble tells you the most urgent fix.

Disasters and events

Fire spreads to neighbours and destroys buildings. Fire Stations put it out.

Storms cost money and damage buildings. **Earthquakes** (from year 3) can collapse buildings. **Grants** give you free money.

Damaged buildings repair themselves slowly. The chance of a disaster grows every year.

How you lose

Money stays below –$500 for **3 months in a row** (watch the "debt x/3" warning on the date), or happiness falls to 0%.

Legacy Shop

Each fallen city earns Legacy (peak pop ÷ 10 + 2 per year survived). Spend it on permanent perks: Seed Fund, Smart Taxes, Prefab, Storm Shield, Civic Pride and Head Start. High scores are kept on the main menu.

Your city auto-saves every few months and when you leave the page. Use **Continue City** to pick up where you left off.

Tips

Keep factories two tiles or more away from homes. Put parks between them.

Upgrading is often cheaper than new land and power.

Build a Fire Station as soon as it unlocks.

If income is negative, demolish idle buildings before debt hits 3 months.